

Element A: Presentation and Justification of the Problem

Many of the teachers and students at our school are wasting paper. They are not recycling or using the paper for other projects. This is a pretty big issue as it affects the environment. There are notebooks with unused paper being left behind every semester by engineering students. The engineering students are only using about half of the paper in the notebooks. Another way paper is being wasted is because a lot of it is being misprinted and deemed unusable, and a piece is printed on one side instead of two. There are a lot of leftover types of paper in the notebooks, such as graphed and ruled. The reason this is happening is because the students only write a semester's worth of material in their notebooks, and teachers are constantly misprinting.

According to FV Recycling (2024), a lot of paper is not only wasted at our school, but at other schools and businesses in the entire world. Other places like offices waste a lot of paper (par. 2). Even outside of these locations people are using paper and notebooks everyday. According to G-BIO Energy (2025), all of the waste is being buried in landfills and decomposing without oxygen. This releases methane gas into the air which traps heat and causes global warming. This is bad for the environment (par. 8). Our goal is to find a way to reuse paper, while benefiting the teachers, faculty, and students.

Recycling the paper or reusing it would make our stakeholders feel good about helping the environment and they would be able to use the paper for other things, such as projects and classwork. Although recycling is a good thing, it could lead to consequences such as, having the school pay money for recycling, and it would be a lot more tiring for faculty if they have to collect the recycling every day. Our primary

stakeholders are the teachers, the faculty (specifically the people who order the paper, and collect the recycling), and the students. Loggers, paper makers, and printing companies would also be very interested in this problem. They do a lot in the process of making paper, printing on it, and recycling.

According to Green America (2026), “if 100% of paper was recycled, we would be able to power 216,000 homes for an entire year” (par. 1). It would save a lot of material and would be more beneficial to teachers and the environment. It is easy to recycle paper and you can use scrap paper. Scrap paper can be used to take notes, draw, and make crafts (‘Becca, 2011). Wasting paper wastes a lot of energy and basic needs of people. We need oxygen from trees, and if we do not do something now, there will not be many trees and there will be less oxygen.

References:

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